Okoth Michael Chariga

Research, Evaluation & Data Systems Specialist

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PROFILE

Research and impact professional with five years of experience in monitoring, evaluation and learning (MEL) systems, participatory agricultural research and data-driven programme design across Kenya and Tanzania. Coordinates partner organisations, builds data systems that field teams can run, deploys R Shiny dashboards for farmer tracking and co-implements randomised controlled trials with research partners. Co-author of maths education papers and presenter at AFRICME7.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- Monitoring, evaluation and learning (MEL) system design
- Baseline, midline and endline studies
- Randomised controlled trial field support
- Participatory and farmer-led research
- Survey design, sampling and field protocols
- Enumerator training and data quality assurance
- Data cleaning, analysis and reporting
- Dashboards: R Shiny, Streamlit, Power BI, Excel
- Partner coordination and capacity building
- Maths education, curriculum and facilitation

EXPERIENCE

Research & Impact Lead

Present

INNODEMS, Kenya

- Lead MEL and research support across agroecology, education and parenting programmes in Kenya and Tanzania, coordinating multiple partner organisations
- Support the Kenya Agroecology Hub and CRFS grantees in western Kenya, directly supporting 10 partner organisations working in agroecology
- Designed and ran a six month pilot in Kuria West testing whether pupils can support farmers in data recording while improving their learning
- Supported Farmer Research Networks on termite management, socio-cultural barriers to agroecology uptake, fermented feeds, and farmer training and follow-up, funded by CRFS (McKnight), the Agroecology Fund and the Conservation Food and Health Foundation
- Co-authored the Field Assessment Report for the Kenya Agroecology Hub (funded by the Conservation Food and Health Foundation): an endline evaluation of farmer training across 10 partner organisations, 42 sub-counties and 223 farmers, assessing 63 agroecology practices
- Design data collection tools in KoboCollect, train data collectors, prepare field protocols, clean and analyse data, and build dashboards in Python, Excel and R Shiny
- Deployed R Shiny dashboards used to track more than 1,000 farmers and managed the evaluation budget alongside the finance lead
- Supported the ParentApp for Teens randomised controlled trial in Mwanza, Tanzania, for the Global Parenting Initiative, in collaboration with the National Institute for Medical Research (NIMR), Mwanza Centre: collected caregiver consent, followed up participants and resolved app problems on their phones

Volunteer Facilitator and Evaluation Support

Ongoing

Africa Maths Initiative (AMI), East Africa

- Created and facilitated hands-on, gamified maths lessons at camps including the STEM BootCamp with Project Inspire (Arusha), Kongoni (twice), Nyahera Girls, Nyarongi (twice), Rombo Girls and Good Shepherd Minor Seminary
- Part of the Africa Maths Initiative team that has run 26 maths camps since 2022
- Designed baseline and endline data collection tools, analysed camp data and contributed to camp reports, covering 13 camps and over 3,000 participants
- Co-authored two maths camp papers and presented the AMI camps at the AFRICME7 conference in Johannesburg
- Supported international volunteers with travel logistics and local planning

EDUCATION

BSc Mathematics with IT, Masinde Muliro University of Science and Technology — 2022

Postgraduate Diploma in Leadership and Accountability, Open University of Kenya — In progress

Aspire Leaders Program, Aspire Institute — 2025

PUBLICATIONS AND PRESENTATIONS

- **Facilitating a Positive Shift in Students' Engagement with Mathematics: Insights from 21 Maths Camps**. AFRICME7 Book of Conference Proceedings, 2025
- **From Players to Pedagogues: The AMI Maths Camp Model as a Catalyst for Teacher Professional Learning**. Mathematics Teacher Education and Development, Awaiting publication
- **Digital Math Activities and Parent-Child Playful Learning with the Early Family Math (EFM) App**. Co-authored paper

REPORTS

- **Field Assessment Report: Improving Farmer Training on AE Practices Through Collaboration and Follow-up**. Kenya Agroecology Hub, Manor House Agricultural Centre, with Muchugia Susan, 2026
- **Promoting Student Learning in Support of a Farmer Research Network in Migori County: Report on a Pilot Study**. Co-author, with Tekviah Munandi, Esther Njeri and Evans Odhiambo
- **Exploring Farmer Practices and Perspectives on Using Tephrosia for Internal and External Livestock Parasite Treatments: Findings from Focus Group Discussions**. Author, Rural Farmers Research Network, January 2025
- **Fermented Feeds Research: Lab Results and Nutrient Analysis Report**. Kenya Agroecology Hub Community of Practice presentation, 2026

AWARDS

- KENET conference funding to present at AFRICME7, Wits School of Education, Johannesburg (2025)
- Aspire Leaders Program alumnus (2025)

TOOLS

R and R Shiny · Python and Streamlit · SQL · KoboToolbox and KoboCollect · ODK · SurveyCTO · CommCare · Power BI · Excel · Notion · GitHub

Referees available on request.